

AEF Key Achievements: Women's Leadership, Youth Civic Engagement and Adolescent Girls' Protection

Action for Equality Foundation (AEF) is a South Sudanese women-led organization committed to advancing gender equality, protection, women's and girls' rights, inclusive governance, youth participation and community-led solutions.

Through community-based programming and partnerships, AEF has supported women, youth and adolescent girls to participate meaningfully in peacebuilding, local governance and protection initiatives. The following achievements demonstrate AEF's practical experience in community engagement, gender-responsive programming, civic participation and protection.

1. Women-Led Community Dialogue and Peacebuilding

Strengthening Women's Leadership and Community Protection: AEF implemented a **women-led community dialogue and peacebuilding initiative across Central and Western Equatoria States**, creating opportunities for women and community members to participate in dialogue, conflict prevention and local protection processes.

A key result of the initiative was the establishment of **four functional community peace committees**. The committees provided community-level platforms for dialogue, conflict prevention and engagement on issues affecting vulnerable and marginalized groups. The initiative strengthened women's participation in community decision-making and peacebuilding while contributing to local efforts to prevent and respond to protection concerns, including gender-based violence.

Key Result

4 functional community peace committees established across Central and Western Equatoria States.

Contribution to AEF's Programming

This experience demonstrates AEF's capacity to:

1. Facilitate women-led community dialogue;
2. Support women's leadership in peacebuilding and local decision-making;
3. Establish and strengthen community-based structures;
4. Engage communities on protection and gender-related concerns;
5. Promote inclusive participation of marginalized groups; and
6. Link community dialogue with broader protection and gender-equality programming.

2. Youth Civic Engagement and Inclusive Local Governance

Strengthening Youth Participation in Decision-Making : AEF supported **youth-led grassroots coalitions in Central Equatoria and Jonglei States**, creating opportunities for young people to participate more actively in local governance and decision-making processes.

Through civic engagement and community mobilization, youth were supported to engage in **county-level budgetary planning sessions**, providing an opportunity for young people to raise community priorities and contribute to discussions concerning local development and resource allocation.

The initiative promoted youth voice and participation in local governance and demonstrated the importance of creating accessible platforms through which young people can engage with local authorities and decision-makers.

Key Result

Youth-led grassroots coalitions supported to participate in county-level budget planning and local governance processes in Central Equatoria and Jonglei States.

Contribution to AEF's Programming

This experience strengthens AEF's capacity to:

1. Mobilize and organize youth-led community initiatives;
2. Facilitate constructive engagement between young people and local authorities;
3. Promote inclusive civic participation;
4. Support youth representation in decision-making processes;
5. Strengthen community accountability; and
6. Integrate youth participation into broader governance, protection and empowerment programming.

3. Adolescent Girls' Dignity, Menstrual Health and Protection

Supporting Dignity, Health and Protection of Adolescent Girls: With support from UNFPA, AEF reached 200 adolescent girls and young people in Juba through the provision of dignity kits.

The intervention addressed practical menstrual health and hygiene needs while promoting dignity, confidence and the ability of adolescent girls to continue participating in education and community activities.

AEF supported the community-level identification and engagement of adolescent girls and young people, facilitated awareness and sensitization on menstrual health and hygiene, and provided participants with information on relevant protection and referral services.

The intervention demonstrated AEF's ability to combine in-kind assistance with community-based protection, awareness and empowerment activities.

Key Result

200 adolescent girls and young people in Juba reached with UNFPA-supported dignity kits, complemented by menstrual health, protection and referral information.

Contribution to AEF's Programming

The experience provides a practical foundation for AEF to integrate:

1. Menstrual health and hygiene education;
2. Dignity and protection support;
3. Adolescent-friendly community engagement;
4. Protection and referral information;
5. Safe referral pathways;
6. Safeguarding and PSEA messaging;
7. Gender-responsive assistance; and
8. Adolescent girls' empowerment into broader GBV prevention and risk-mitigation programming.

What These Achievements Demonstrate

Together, these initiatives demonstrate AEF's experience in women's leadership, community engagement, youth participation, gender-responsive programming and protection-focused interventions.

AEF's approach is grounded in working with communities and supporting women, girls and young people to participate in identifying priorities and developing locally appropriate solutions.

The three areas of experience provide a foundation for AEF's broader programming in GBV prevention and response, protection, women and girls' empowerment, adolescent engagement, community accountability, safeguarding and inclusive governance.

AEF's Key Results at a Glance

Area	Key Result
Women's Leadership &	4 functional community peace committees established across Central

Area	Key Result
Peacebuilding	and Western Equatoria
Youth Civic Engagement	Youth-led coalitions supported to participate in county-level budget planning and local governance
Adolescent Girls' Protection & Dignity	200 adolescent girls and young people reached in Juba with UNFPA-supported dignity kits and related MHM/protection information

Evidence of Relevant Programme Experience

AEF has implemented women-led community dialogue and peacebuilding initiatives, supported youth participation in local governance, and reached 200 adolescent girls and young people in Juba with UNFPA-supported dignity kits, complemented by menstrual health, protection and referral information.

These experiences demonstrate AEF's practical capacity to engage women, girls, youth and communities through gender-responsive, protection-sensitive and community-led programming.

Further details and supporting evidence:

[Insert AEF webpage URL]

For partnership and programme enquiries:

Action for Equality Foundation (AEF)

South Sudan